# Because

The analyst agent that shows its work. Ask why something happened and audit every claim.

**TRACK**

Explain Why

**TEAM**

OlsOls Agents

# Why questions get fluent answers that nobody can check.

LLMs explain fluently but unverifiably.
Dashboards show what changed, never why.
Doing it properly takes hours of pulling and lining up sources.

# Who it is for

### Analysts

Explain a margin or revenue move from filings in seconds, with the bridge in points of revenue.

### Journalists

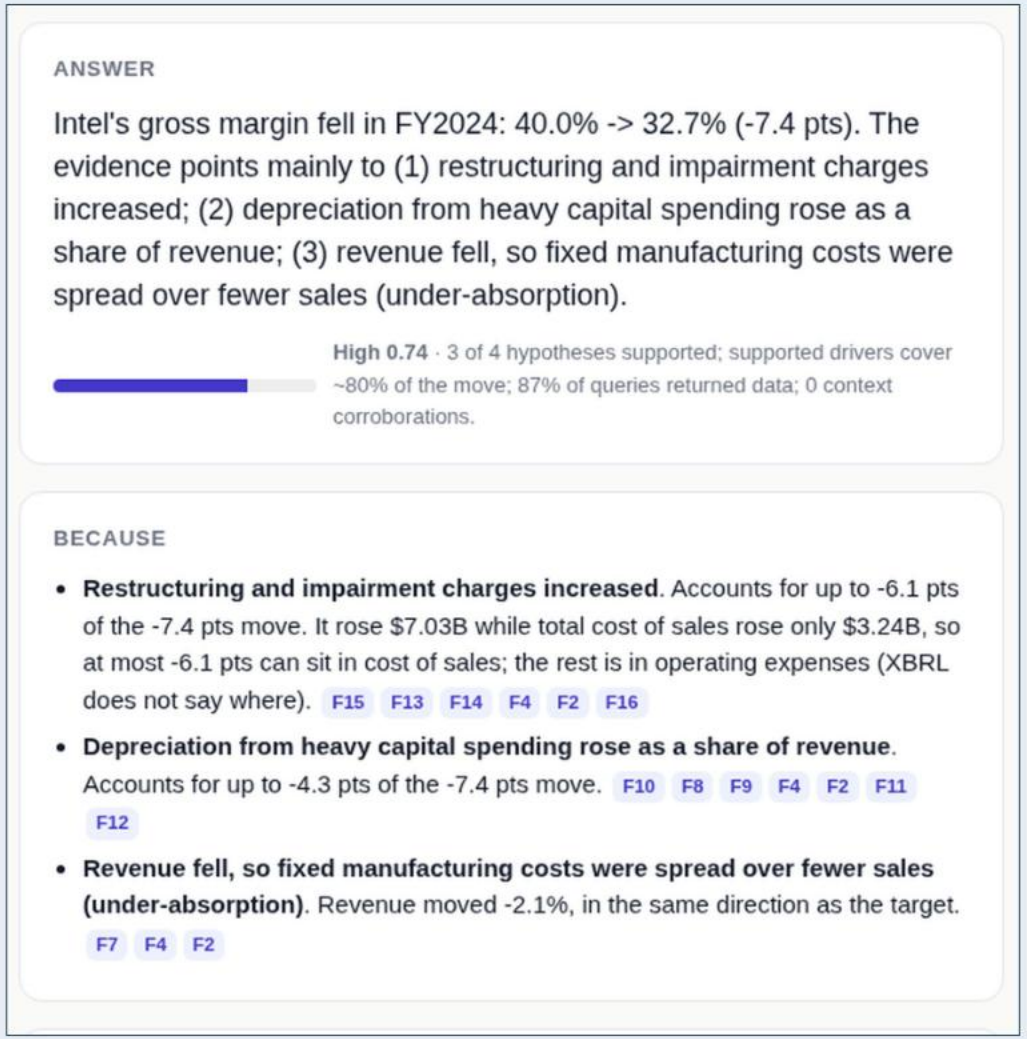
Check a claimed cause of inflation or unemployment against official series before publishing.

### Students and investors

Learn to reason from evidence: see the hypotheses that failed, not just the answer.

# Ask why then audit

Intel's 2024 gross margin from SEC filings. Every claim cites findings; every finding cites a query and a source row.



# One investigation

**SCOUT**

Classifies the question, runs the guard and issues an HMAC-signed contract for the allowed tools.

**RECALL**

H-MEM returns what the agent already believes and which query it came from.

**QUERY AND TEST**

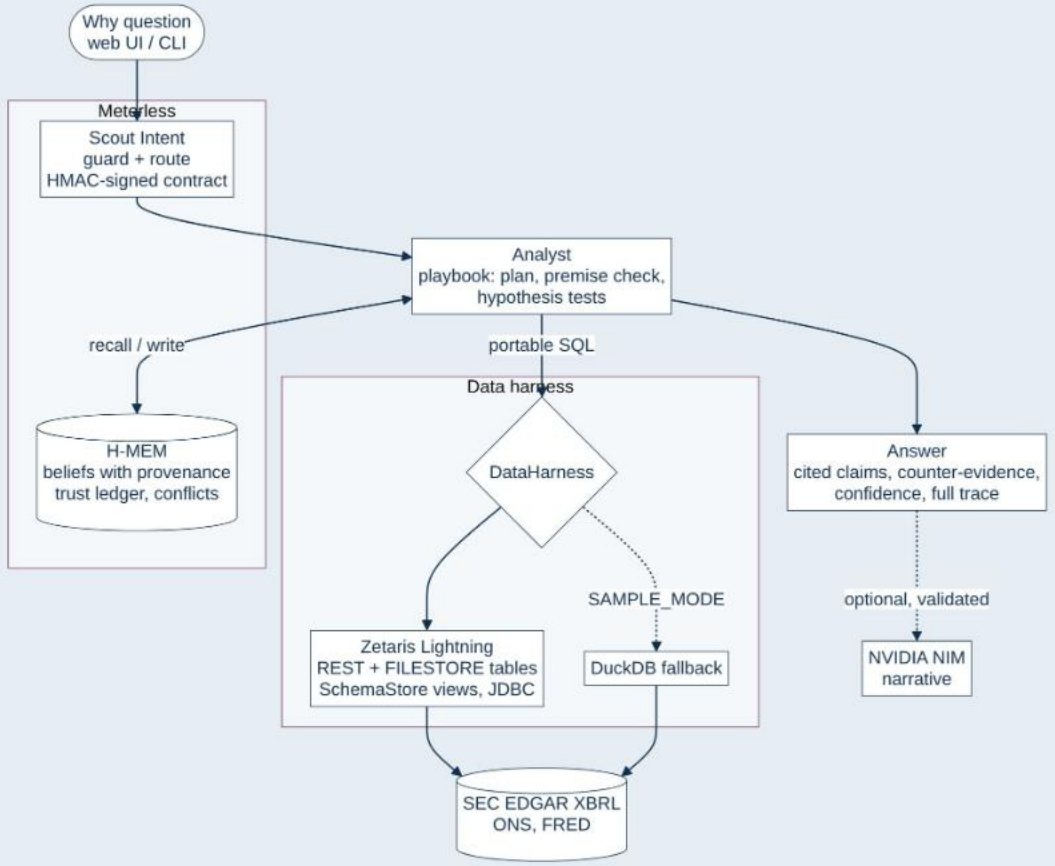
Zetaris SQL pulls target and drivers. Each hypothesis gets a numeric rule and a verdict.

**ANSWER AND REMEMBER**

Cited claims, counter-evidence and confidence; every finding is written back with provenance.

# Architecture

Meterless decides and remembers. Zetaris federates the data. The same portable SQL runs on a DuckDB fallback.



# 01

# Sponsor technology

Zetaris federates. Meterless decides and remembers.

```
-- Lightning SQL that `because zetaris register` runs (generated by `because zetaris ddl`).
-- One statement per JDBC call. FRED tables need a free FRED_API_KEY (shown here as ***).
CREATE LIGHTNING DATABASE BECAUSE_REST DESCRIBE BY "Because agent public REST sources - SEC EDGAR, ONS, FRED";

CREATE SCHEMASTORE CONTAINER because;

CREATE LIGHTNING REST TABLE edgar_concept_0000050863_revenues_raw FROM BECAUSE_REST REQUEST(
    endpoint "https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyconcept/CIK0000050863/us-gaap/Revenues.json",
    method "get",
    response_type "json",
    http_encoding "URLENCODED"
) HEADER (
    user-agent "because-agent you@example.com"
) BODY ();

CREATE SCHEMASTORE VIEW edgar_concept_0000050863_revenues WITH CONTAINER because AS
SELECT
    CAST(cik AS STRING) AS cik,
```

Three public source families federated by Lightning, queried with one portable SQL dialect.

# Zetaris is the data harness

## Tables

SEC, ONS as REST tables; FRED as FILESTORE CSV

## Channels

JDBC, UI SQL proxy or REST

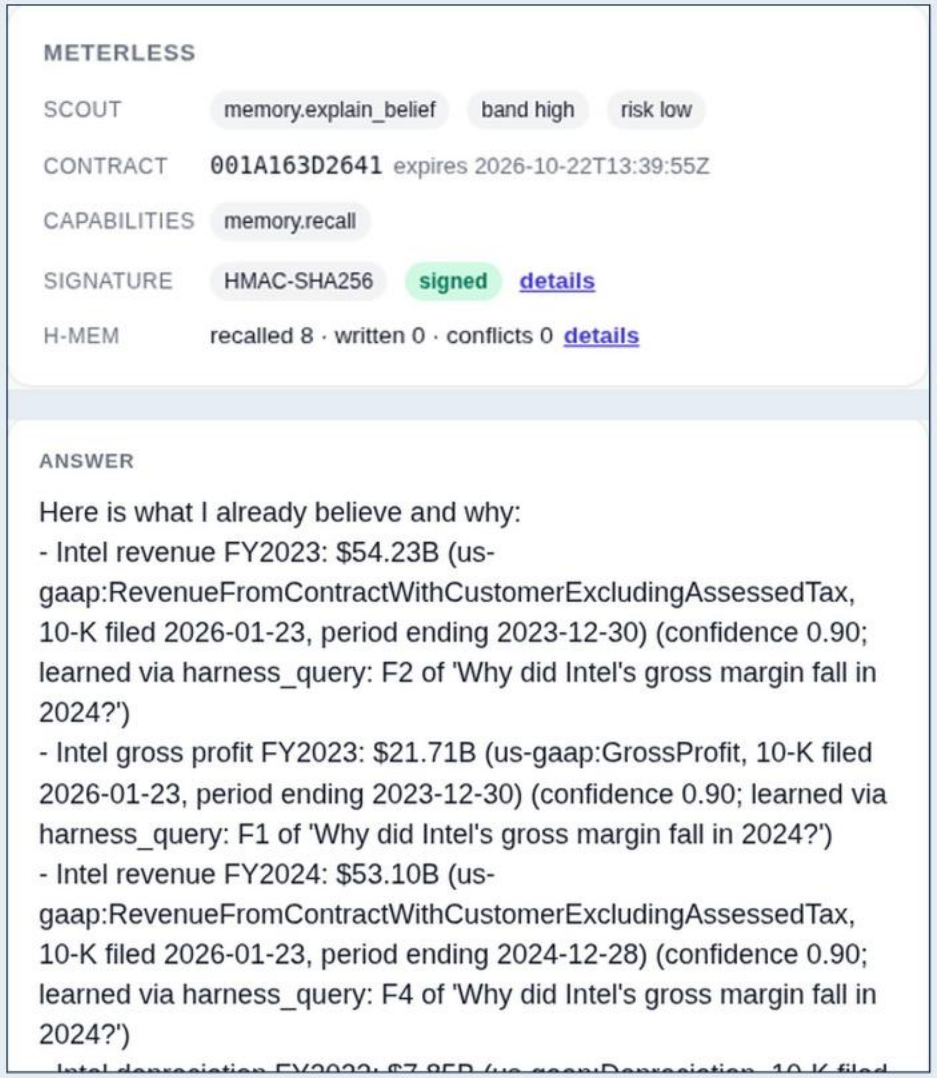
## CI

Real Lightning bundle on GitHub Actions

**H-MEM** Every finding is a memory with SQL, rows and source URL. Conflict scan flags restated numbers.

**SCOUT INTENT** Intent registry, five-layer guard, HMAC-SHA256 contracts with TTL and scope checks.

**ASK IT WHY** Memory recall answers what it believes and audits the trail behind each belief.




# Meterless remembers why

H-MEM stores beliefs with the query that produced them. Scout gates every tool call.

# Cursor Agent CLI session: 01-zetaris-backend-hardening

- date: 2026-10-22T12:24:22Z
- cli: cursor-agent 2026.10.19-6bbf2c4
- model: auto
- command: cursor-agent -p --force --trust --model auto --output-format stream-json ""

## Prompt

```
You are working in the Because repo (read AGENTS.md and .cursor/rules first). Task: harden the Zetaris backend (becau

1. Column labels: the Lightning JDBC driver (Hive-style) may return labels like `view_name.col` or `because.view.col`

2. Caching: the Zetaris REST cookbook says a Lightning REST table re-fetches its endpoint on every query unless cache
```

Three headless Cursor Agent CLI sessions did real work, logged in the repo.

# Built in Cursor

### Rules

AGENTS.md and .cursor/rules

### Sessions

Zetaris hardening, FRED FILESTORE, UI polish

### NVIDIA

NIM is the first-choice narrative LLM

# 02

# Proof and next

Conformance, tests and the road ahead.

# Results

| 13/13 | 1.00 | 58 | 0.70–0.94 |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| H-MEM conformance | Scout eval top-1 | Offline tests | Confidence on 4 saved runs |

# Stack

| LAYER | TECHNOLOGY |
| --- | --- |
| Routing | Meterless Scout Intent |
| Memory | Meterless H-MEM |
| Data harness | Zetaris Lightning, DuckDB fallback |
| Data | SEC EDGAR, ONS, FRED, Wikipedia |
| Narrative | NVIDIA NIM, Groq or Gemini |
| App | Python, FastAPI, Vercel |

# Next

**Semantic layer**
Zetaris USL model joining EDGAR facts and macro series

**Markovian**
Bounded state for long, multi-company investigations

**Richer data**
CPI weights, XBRL segments, Eurostat

**Dreaming**
Cross-question insights proposed for approval

# Read the trace

because-agent.vercel.app ·
github.com/0ls0ls4/because

**DEMO**
because-agent.vercel.app

**CODE**
github.com/0ls0ls4/because